

4.14 Process Explorer

Created by Sysinternals, this is now a Microsoft product after a takeover. Much like the default Windows Task Manager (TM), Process Explorer (PE) focuses on offering live information about the system's workings. PE can show the processes running on the system, along with the system resources consumed by each of them. In addition to the data also brought up by Task Manager—like CPU and RAM usage—PE can also show the files that are being used by a process.



Improve your font display

Graphically, it adds to TM's ability to plot CPU and page file utilisation statistics, by including a I/O bytes graph that plots data transfer rates. Additionally, the graph itself is more informative since each process is plotted in a different colour, and information about the process is available as a tool tip. Information about each process is accessible with a right-click, including the individual program's usage of system resources, its connection to remote IPs in case of programs accessing the Net, and most importantly, a search for the specific process can be made on the Net using MSN's search engine. Processes and Process Trees can be stopped, just as in TM. PE can be configured to show up the next time you do a [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Del] to access the Task Manager, and configuring it thus would be a good idea.